

MCS - 214

Professional Skills and Ethics

Q-1 Read the following passage and answer the questions.

=> Meetings

Do you ever feel as though you spend all your time in meetings?

Henry Mintzberg, in his book *The Nature of Managerial Work*, found that in large organizations, managers spent 22 percent of their time at their desk, 6 percent on the telephone, 3 percent on other activities, but a whopping 69 percent in meetings. There is a widely held but mis-

taken beliefs that meetings are for "solving problems" and "making decisions". For a start, the number of people attending a meeting tends to be inversely proportional to their collectively ability to reach conclusions and make decisions. And these are the least important elements

Instead hours are devoted to side issues, playing elaborate games with one another. It seems, therefore, that meetings serve some purpose other than just making decisions. All meetings have one thing in common: role D playing. The most formal role is that of chairman. He (and it is usually a he) sets the agendas, and a good chairman will keep the meetings running on time and to the point. Sadly, the other, informal, role-players are often able to gain the upper hand. Chief is the "constant talker", who just loves to hear his on her own voice.

Then there are the "can't do" types who want to maintain the status quo. Since they have often been in the organisation for a long time, they frequently quote historical experience as a ploy to block change: "If we didn't work, we tried that in 1984 and it was a disaster".

A more subtle version of the "can't do" type, the "yes, but --", has emerged recently. They have learnt about the need to sound positive, but they still can't bear to have things change.

Another, whole - sub - set of characters are people who love meetings and want them to continue until 5:30 p.m. or beyond. Irrelevant issues are their speciality. They need to call or attend meetings, either to avoid work, or to justify their lack of performance, or simply because they do not have enough to do.

Then there are the "counter-dependents", those who usually disagree with everything that is said, particularly if it comes from the chairman or through consensus from the group. These people need to fight authority in whatever form.

Meetings can also provide attendees with a sense of identification of their status and power.

A popular game is pinching someone else's suggestions. This is where someone, usually junior or female, makes an interesting suggestion early in the meeting, which is not picked up. Much later, the game is played, usually by some more senior figure that propounds the idea as his own. The suggestion is of course identified with the player rather than the imitator.

Because so many meetings end in confusion and without a decision, another more common game is played at the end of meetings, called reaching a false consensus. Since it is important for the chairman to appear successful in problem-solving and making a decision, the group reaches a false consensus. Everyone is happy, having spent their time productively. The reality is that the decision is so ambiguous that it is never acted upon, or, if it is, there is continuing conflict, for which another meeting is necessary.

In the end, meetings provide the opportunity for social intercourses, to engage in battle in front of our bosses, to avoid unpleasant or unsatisfying work, to highlight our social status and identity. They are, in fact, a necessary

productive psychological side show.
Perhaps it is our civilized way of
moderating, if not preventing,
change.

Answer the following questions:

(i) what is the purpose of a meeting according to the writer?

→ The writer except argues that, despite the common belief that meetings are for solving problems and making decisions, their true purpose is something else entirely.

They claim that meetings primarily serve as a platform for social interaction, power plays, and avoiding work, rather than achieving concrete outcomes.

Here are the key points supporting this viewpoint:

- Meetings are rarely effective in

reaching conclusions and making decisions.

- o Meetings fulfill various individual needs!

Different participants use meetings for different purposes.

- o "constant talkers" enjoy hearing their own voice.
- o "can't do" types resist change and cite past experiences as obstacles.
- o Meeting enthusiasts seek to play meetings due to boredom, lack of work,
- o "counter-dependents" disagree for the sake of opposite authority.
- o Some seek to enhance their status and power.
- o Suggestion stacking occurs.

Q-2 write a telephone conversation on the basis of cues given below:

A: Ask to speak to Mr. Andrews (Hint: May I speak to --- ?)

B: He's in a meeting

A: Ask when he'll be free

B: He won't be free till after 6 p.m.

A: you want him to call you first thing tomorrow.

B: Find out caller's name and number:
Give your (real) name and number.

B: Note down the information and say you'll leave the message on his desk.

A: Say thanks and goodbye

Ans- A: Hello, may I speak to Mr. Andrews, please?

B: I'm sorry, he's currently in a meeting.

A: Do you know when he'll be available?

B: I'm not sure. would you like me to find out for you?

A: yes, please, I'll wait.

B: He won't be free until after 6 p.m.

A: Alright, could you ask him to call me first thing tomorrow?

B: Certainly; May I have your name and contact number?

A: It's [your Real Name], and my number is [your Phone Number].

B: Thank you, I'll make sure to pass on the message.

A: Great, thanks, for your help,
Good Bye.

Q-3 write short notes on any four of the following :

i) Significance of Minutes of the meeting.

=> The minutes of a meeting play a crucial role in documenting and preserving the discussions, decisions, and actions taken during a meeting.

Here are some significant aspects of minutes of the meeting:

1. ** Official Record: **

- Minutes serve as an official and legal record of what transpired during meeting.

2. ** Reference Document: **

- Minutes serve as a reference document for participants.

(ii) Interpersonal Skill of a Manager in an organization.

=> Interpersonal skills are crucial for managers in any organisation as they involve the ability to interact, communicate, and build relationships effectively with individuals and groups.

Here are some key interpersonal skills that are particularly important for a manager:

1. ** Communication Skills: **

- Manager need to convey information clearly and concisely. Effective communication includes active listening, articulating ideas, and adapting communication style to different audiences.

2. ** Leadership Skills: **

A manager needs to inspire.

(iii) Do's and Don'ts during Meetings.

⇒ Effective meetings contribute to better communication, collaboration, and decision-making within an organization.

To ensure productive and positive meetings, here are some do's and don'ts to consider:

*** Do's: **

1. ** Set Clear objectives: **

- clearly define the purpose and objectives of the meetings. Ensure that participants understand what needs to be achieved.

2. ** Stay Focused: **

- Stick to the agenda and avoid unnecessary tangents.

(iv) Importance of visual's in Presentations:

⇒ The use of visuals in presentation, is highly important and can significantly enhance the effectiveness of the communication.

Here are several reasons why visuals are crucial in presentations:

1. ** Improved Understanding: **

Visuals, such as charts, graphs and diagrams, can simplify complex information and make it easier for the audience to understand. Visual aids provide a visual representation of data.

2. ** Versatility: **

- Visual come in various forms, including slides, charts, images, videos, and infographics. This versatility allows presenters to choose the messages.

Q-4 you work for a company, which manufactures external hard disks and pen drives. you are visiting another company, "Agitech", to buy some accounting software for your finance department.

They have expressed an interest in your company's external hard disks and pen-drives. you would like to take twenty brochures and three sample external hard disks and pen-drives with you.

- write a memo to Mr. John, the stores manager.
- Ask for his permission to take these items.
- Explain the time and date when you want to collect them.
- Say what you hope to achieve by showcasing these products.

Ams. [your company Letterhead]

[Date]

To: Mr. John

Stores Manager

Ajitech

Subject: Request for Permission to
take Marketing Materials.

Dear Mr. John,

I hope this memo you feel, I am writing to request your permissions to collect marketing materials from our inventory for an upcoming visit to Ajitech, where I will be discussing the purchase of accounting software for our finance department.

I would like to take with me

twenty brochures and three sample external hard disks and pen drives to showcase our company's products during the meetings. The purpose of showcasing these products is to provide Ajitech with a comprehensive understanding of the range and quality of our external storage solutions.

I assure you that the promotional materials will be used solely for the purpose of showcasing our products during the meeting, and they will be handled with the utmost care. I understand the importance of maintain our company.

Best regards,

[your Full Name]

[your Position]

[your company name.]

Q-5 Read the advertisement below and write your Curriculum vitae on the basis of it.

Printer Sales Executives (South Delhi)
For a
Leading Multinational Company

We are looking for young, dynamic males/females interested in selling various types of Printers.

The position is based in Delhi and the candidates will be responsible for sales in Punjab, Uttar Pradesh.

No experience required but working knowledge of Printers is essential.

Apply to Ms. Amuradhan
Personal Executive
ABC Co. (Pvt.) Ltd.
P.O. BOX: 3675

Ans- a job advertisement for printer sales executives. It is based in Delhi and the candidates will be responsible for sales in Punjab, Uttar Pradesh, Himachal and Uttarakhand.

Here are the steps on how to write a CV for the position:

1. Start with your contact information, including your name, email address, and phone number.
2. Write a summary of your qualifications and experience. This should be brief and highlight your most relevant skills and experience.
3. List your work experience in reverse chronological order. For each job, include the company name, your job title, and the dates you were there, even if it was not in the printing industry.
4. List your education and training.

Include the name of the school you attended, your degree, and any relevant coursework.

5. list your skills and abilities. This could include your computer skills, communication skills, and problem-solving skills.

6. Proofread your CV carefully before submitting it.

Here is an example of a CV that you could use:

your Name your Email Address

your Phone Number.

Summary I am a highly motivated and results-oriented individual with a strong track-record of success in sales.

work Experiences:

Q-6. last year, the indian Trade Fair 2023 was held at the Bharat Mandapam, Pragathi Maidan, Delhi from November 10 to 20. The fair was organized by the Trade Fair Authority of India (TFAI). The fair was open from 11 a.m. to 9 p.m. all the days for public.

It was an all india fair. Traders and Manufacturers from all the states participated in it. The aim of the fair was to bring together the buyers and sellers of goods manufactured in different parts of india and promote trade and industry in the country.

=> last year, the indian Trade fair 2023 was held at the Bharat Mandapam, Pragathi Maidan, Delhi from November 10 to 20. The fair was organized by the Trade Fair Authority of India (TFAI). The fair was open from 11 a.m.

Q7: These are the answers to ten questions.
Example: who does Rahul for?

i) ————— He is the Marketing Director.

ii) ————— There are five Directors at JTV.

iii) ————— He lives in Mumbai.

iv) ————— He starts work at 8:30 a.m.

v) ————— Next week he's going to a trade fair in Abu Dhabi.

vi) ————— He joined the company six years ago.

vii) ————— He has been Marketing Director since 2017.

viii) ————— Before joining JTV, he worked for FANTASTECH India.

ix) ————— He was with them for seven years.

x) ————— He left because of a misunderstanding.

Ans-

The prompt is to write wh-questions for the following statements:

- He is the Marketing Director.
- There are five Directors at JTV.
- He lives in Mumbai.
- He starts work at 8:30 a.m.
- Next week he's going to a trade fair in Abudhabi.
- He joined the company six years ago.
- He has been Marketing Director since 2017.
- He was with them for seven years.
- He left because of a misunderstanding.

Q-8 Prepare a presentation on any one of the following:

- (i) Presentation on any software MNC (or else the company where you work)
- (ii) Any hardware (latest) product
- (iii) A software project you have been involved in recently.
- (iv) Emerging Technologies in your working area.

Before you begin, indicate:

- i) you and audience
- ii) who they are
- iii) if it's a formal or informal occasion.

Indicates any props you may need
e.g. white board, overhead projector,

Power point; etc. The presentation must be in about 200 words.

Ams-

Title:-

Presentation on emerging Technologies in Data Analysis.

1 ** Introduction: **

(i) *** Presenter and Audience: **

- Good [morning / afternoon / evening], everyone. My name is [your Name], and I am a [your Position] at [your company / organization]. Today, I am excited to share insights on the emerging technologies in the field of data analytics.

(ii) ** Audience: **

- The audience comprises colleagues from various departments, including data scientists, analysts, project.

Q9 Prepare minutes for an official meeting that was held in XYZ company (or in your company where you are working) to discuss the quarterly sales report of a product and future plans to promote it further.

Ans- [your Company Letterhead]

** Minutes of the Meeting **

** Meeting Title : **

Quarterly Sales Report and Future Plans
for [Product Name]

** Date : ** [Date]

** Time : ** [Start time] to [End time]

** Location : ** [Meeting Room /
location]

** Present : **

1. [your full name]-

Chairperson.

2. [Attendee 1] -

Sales Manager

3. [Attendee 2] -

Marketing Manager

4. [Attendee 3] -

Finance Representative

5. [Attendee 4] -

Product Development Representative

6. [Attendee 5] -

Operations Manager.

** Agenda : **